He's On Her Mind

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/78851796.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Entrapta & Hordak (She-Ra), Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra), Emily & Entrapta (She-Ra)

Characters:
Entrapta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Emily (She-Ra), Darla | Mara's Ship (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Angst, Angst with a Hopeful Ending, Nightmares, Dreams and Nightmares, entrapta is not having a good time, Flashbacks, Scorpia is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Hordak's LUVD Crystal (She-Ra), Fluff, Fluff and Angst, Angst and Feels

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by yourfellowhuman

Summary

"Entrapta slammed her hands on the console of the ship, eyes watering. Why couldn’t she stop thinking about him? For the past 152 hours and 38 minutes, all her mind could conjure was his name. On Beast Island, she was too distracted by the danger and discoveries to think of him, but now…. Now, he was at the forefront of all her thoughts."

_____

Entrapta has been working on fixing Darla, but she can't get a certain man out of her head.

Thankfully, Scorpia comes in to clarify some things.

Notes

Entrapta angst!

See the end of the work for more notes

A week had passed since Prime's invasion had begun, and Entrapta was elbow deep inside the wires of the First Ones' ship, which she had lovingly named Darla.

Since she was basically the only one who knew anything about First Ones' tech, she was quickly told to make the ship spaceworthy. While Entrapta wasn't exactly thrilled about being *told* to fix the ship, she was still excited to work on it! It was the largest piece of First Ones' tech she had ever gotten her hands on, and it wasn't just a piece of tech! It was an almost fully functioning spaceship! Oh, imagine if Hordak could see this! He loves-

Fixing the ship should be relatively easy, but time-consuming. Many of the wires had shorted out, parts of the ship had rusted, and there were massive amounts of sand everywhere. Her only real issue would be trying to figure out all the mechanisms, such as the gravity adjusters and autopilot controls. Perhaps if her lab partner were here, then Entrapta could get some helpful in-

Entrapta was lucky to find the supplies to fix the ship. She had some tools hidden in Brightmoon that she managed to swipe before the Alliance had abandoned the palace. Thankfully, she got her hands on some old, destroyed Etherian Horde bots she was able to scrap for parts. She noticed some had new designs. She had seen sketches of them in Hordak's sanc-

She wasn't exactly happy they abandoned Brightmoon. She much preferred working in a controlled environment, such as Hordak's-

Still, it was nice to be back with her friends in the Alliance, especially since she learned that they, in fact, did not abandon her in the Fright Zone. They actually wanted to save her, unlike Hordak, who-

Entrapta slammed her hands on the console of the ship, eyes watering. Why couldn't she stop thinking about *him*? For the past 152 hours and 38 minutes, all her mind could conjure was *his* name. On Beast Island, she was too distracted by the danger and discoveries to think of *him*, but now…. Now, *he* was at the forefront of all her thoughts.

After arriving on Beast Island, Entrapta quickly assumed either Hordak had banished her there or that he didn't know she had been sent there. For her own comfort, she decided to focus on the latter idea, even if the former was more likely. When imagining the latter, she thought Hordak would quickly find out. Emily was there to record the whole thing, and Scorpia could never keep a secret.

Entrapta waited and waited and waited, but no one came. Not Scorpia. Not Catra. And, especially, not Hordak. None of the friends she had made in the Fright Zone even attempted to rescue her. Sure, Scorpia eventually told the Alliance about her fate, but that was after Entrapta spent a year on that island.

After a while, Entrapta gave up hope that someone was coming to rescue her, and thankfully, she found the First Ones' tech at the same time, keeping her mind occupied enough to ward off the island's signal.

Then, a few months later, the Alliance rescued her.

She was grateful that they rescued her, but even she could tell they only wanted her back because she could work with tech. It wasn't surprising. She had sided with the Etherian Horde, even if it was because she thought they abandoned her there. Regardless, the Alliance had made their aversion to her quite evident.

Therefore, she avoided most of them. She, of course, talked to Bow and Adora. Both of them were chomping at the bit to go into space and save their friend (Entrapta could never remember her name). Entrapta, of course, was ecstatic about going to space, but she needed time to fix the ship, and Bow and Adora were only slowing her down by constantly asking about her progress. Maybe if she had Hordak here, this would be going-

STOP! STOP! STOP!

Hordak doesn't matter anymore. He got what he wanted, and he didn't care enough to come and rescue her.

All Hordak wanted to do was build a portal and go home to his people. Entrapta was just a stepping stone. In fact, she should be happy that the goal of getting Hordak back was achieved….

She should be.

But then, there was this ache deep within her heart that tore at her when she thought of him leaving her.

She loved Hordak.

It was undeniable.

Whether he truly cared about her or not, he still listened to her, made sure she slept when the hours grew late, and defended her when Catra got onto her.

Well, he used to defend her from Catra.

Entrapta had stopped working on the ship at that point. Instead, she stared blankly at the mess of wires in her hands. Slowly, she let them fall from her fingers. She sank to the floor, hiding herself within her hair.

Gullible.

That was the label she had been given since she was young.

Gullible Princess Enrapta… Always so easily manipulated into doing whatever anyone wanted.

Of course, the first man to ever give her any positive attention stole her heart. He flattered her and gave her anything she wanted, and in return, Entrapta helped him arm his forces and worked on his projects.

And then, when the portal was complete… he got rid of her.

That was the only part that didn't make sense to her. Hordak and Entrapta, during what little downtime they had, would discuss potential future projects they would work on while awaiting Horde Prime. Oftentimes, Hordak had to stop her from starting them right then and quickly assured her they would work on them later.

In the year that Entrapta knew Hordak, he had never once lied to her or anyone else she knew. That is one of the many reasons she loved him.

Maybe getting rid of her was a spur-of-the-moment decision. No, that didn't make sense either. Hordak was more sensible than that…. Was he?

Stars, Entrapta was tired. Hot, silent tears were falling down her cheeks; her breath was deep but labored. She was fidgeting with the seams of her clothes, trying to distract herself to no avail.

What did all this matter anyway? Hordak was with his family, and Entrapta was in the Wider Universe.

They both got what they wanted.

Entrapta should be happy, even after Hordak's betrayal.

Still, it all felt hollow without him.

"Hordak!" Entrapta called, the doors to the Sanctum shutting behind her as she wheeled the massive piece of First Ones' tech further into Hordak's laboratory. She was so distracted by the new tech that she didn't notice that the Sanctum had an odd, hazy quality to it. Sharp lines were fuzzy, and there was nothing but shadow in her peripheral vision.

"Entrapta," Hordak responded, a little startled. "You've returned." Entrapta looked over to see him at one of the monitors, scrambling to shut down a program she didn't recognize. He also seemed to have ditched his cape, so she definitely caught him by surprise.

"Of course I did," she said absentmindedly. "Ta-da!" Entrapta had stopped to present the tech to Hordak, splaying out her hands and hair with enthusiasm. This gained Hordak's full attention, the

Warlord walking toward her to get a closer look. “This baby can power our portal and maybe even the entire Fright Zone! What do you think?”

“Impressive…” Hordak trailed. Entrapta, while still propping up the tech, raised herself on her hair and admired the piece of tech along with Hordak.

“I know! It’s amazing,” Entrapta then began moving away, ready to spring into action at a moment’s notice. She had subconsciously wound a lock of hair around Hordak’s metal bicep, trying to pull him along with her. “Let’s get started. I think-”

Entrapta stopped when she felt a tug on her hair. She looked over her shoulder to see her hair wrapped firmly around Hordak’s arm and Hordak stubbornly staying in place.

“Oh, sorry…” Entrapta’s hair released Hordak’s arm. She waited for him to say something about it, but he seemed to brush it off. A small wave of embarrassment had flowed through Entrapta, along with the tempting itch to lower her mask over her face.

“Entrapta.” When Hordak uttered her name, Entrapta felt time stop. Their eyes met, and Entrapta’s breath caught in her throat. She usually hated looking into other people’s eyes, but something about Hordak’s large, crimson, pupilless eyes put the Princess at ease, especially when he was looking at her so softly. Had he ever looked at her like that? Was her mind playing tricks on her? “Remember how you were struggling to comprehend what the stars looked like.”

Entrapta, still caught up in the unnaturally soft look in Hordak's eyes, was unable to respond but managed to nod her head.

"While you were gone, I needed something to work on," Hordak then began to lead her into a darker part of the lab. One of his hands had settled into the small of her back, gently pushing her along. What… what was happening? Entrapta's rational mind wanted to question Hordak, but the giddy part of herself was too eager to see what Hordak was planning. It felt a little intoxicating. She didn't even notice how the First Ones' tech had miraculously disappeared the moment Hordak's hand brushed her. "So I thought it would be best to show you what I was talking about."

Entrapta frowned when Hordak's hand left her back. He turned to another monitor with the same program from earlier. He was about to type something in when he stopped himself.

"Close your eyes, will you?" Hordak requested, looking over his shoulder.

"Huh?"

"Close your eyes," he repeated slowly but gently.

Entrapta did as she was told, covering her eyes with her hands. Her hair fidgeted as she listened to the anticipatory sound of the

key clacking on Hordak's keyboard.

"Alright," Hordak practically whispered in her ear. (When had he moved to stand behind her?) "Open your eyes, Princess."

Any questions melted away when Entrapta saw the projection before her. Thousands of little lights twinkled around her, all different shapes and colors. The sight was dizzying and dreamlike. It was no wonder Hordak was so eager to return to all this.

"Do you like it?" Hordak asked expectantly, taking both her hands in his own.

"Yes, Hordak, I love… I love it so much," Entrapta threaded her gloveless (when had she taken off her gloves?) fingers through Hordak's. "Thank you."

Before Entrapta could register anything else, Hordak was kissing her. It wasn't just a ghosting of the lips, but an actual kiss. Entrapta didn't even care that Hordak never leaned down to kiss her; his lips just appeared on hers without any rhyme or reason.

Hordak's arm wound around her waist, and his other hand threaded through her hair. Why was this happening? Entrapta knew this all felt wrong, but she was too caught up in the moment to care. Time felt like it stilled as Entrapta's eyes fluttered closed. She wound her arms around Hordak's neck, and the entire world faded away. She felt safe. Safer than ever before.

Entrapta parted from him, but only for a moment to catch her breath.

But the moment her lips pulled away, she felt a sharp, electric pain stab her lower back. Entrapta's arms flew away from Hordak; the smell of burning flesh clogged her nose. All of a sudden, Hordak had melted away, and Entrapta opened her eyes to see the jagged landscape of Beast Island. A sob tore through Entrapta's throat as her still gloveless hands and now dirty hair flew to pull her mask over her face, but it wasn't there. Her eyes, welling with tears, looked at the ground to see her mask lying in the sand. The metal was bent and torn, while the lenses were shattered. A single tear fell from her eyes and splattered on the mask.

When Entrapta tried to blink the rest of her tears away, the world around her hand morphed to the mess of scrap metal and wires that made up the Fright Zone. What was once her mask, lying on the ground, was replaced by the crystal that powered Hordak's armor. The very object she had etched her undying love for an ungrateful man lay discarded among the wreckage.

Just then, a shadow engulfed her frame. Entrapta hoped that it would be Hordak's towering figure, but Entrapta instead looked up to see one of Horde Prime's ships looming overhead. Entrapta collapsed to her knees at the sight, curling in on herself as she clutched the crystal, its sharp points digging into her skin.

"Entrapta," a faraway voice called. Entrapta didn't register it, though, too caught up in her own grief. "Entrapta!" The voice was

growing louder, more insistent, but not enough to break through to Entrapta. “ENTRAPTA!”

Entrapta jerked awake. Her hair was curled tightly around her like a protective cocoon. Her bug-like mask was set firmly on her face; her gloves were still on her sensitive hands. Entrapta balled up her fists, feeling the wrinkles of the fabric in her grip.

“Entrapta,” a familiar voice sighed. Entrapta let her hair unfurl to see Scorpia crouched down to her level on the floor. Entrapta saw that she was smiling, but whatever finer feelings Scorpia was imprinting on her face were completely lost to the Princess.

Entrapta was happy to see Scorpia again when they reunited. She had just gotten back from Beast Island and was overjoyed to see anyone she vaguely knew. Still, there was this morsel of resentment that Scorpia didn’t defend Entrapta from Catra or try to look for her sooner. Sure, they hadn’t really hung out a lot in the weeks before her banishment, but still. Entrapta had always been told about the importance of showing up and helping friends; it was why she was so willing to help the Alliance and the Horde with tech. So, why hadn’t Scorpia come for her sooner? Was she not worth it until recently?

Regardless, Entrapta knew that being mad at Scorpia was a waste of time. And hey, at least Scorpia did make an effort to rescue her, even if she had to get the Alliance to do it.

“Hey, are you okay?” Scorpia asked, her smile dropping.

Entrapta's hair came to life in an instant, carrying her to another part of the room. Entrapta made sure to keep her mask on her face so Scorpia couldn’t see how red and puffy her eyes were.

“I’m great!” Entrapta replied plastically. “Just getting some sleep.” Entrapta then pulled a random panel off the wall and started fiddling with the wires, trying to look busy.

“Good.. Uh- That’s good.” Entrapta thought she had fooled Scorpia, but Scorpia could tell her friend was on edge. “Hey, Entrapta-”

“Hm?” Entrapta had turned her neck and shoulders to look at Scorpia. Entrapta’s body and hair looked rigid, like she was ready to run at a moment’s notice. And, because of the way the light was hitting her mask, Scorpia caught a glimpse of Entrapta’s bloodshot eyes.

“I just- I wanted to say I’m sorry.” Scorpia approached Entrapta tentatively. “I really messed up by going along with Catra for so long. She was a horrible friend, and you had always been so nice to me-”

“It’s fine,” Entrapta said flatly.

“Huh- What?”

“It’s. Fine.” Entrapta repeated. Entrpta turned back to the ship’s wires. “I’m alive. No harm done.”

“Entrapta…” Scorpia trailed, feeling her heart break a little. “Entrapta no.”

“I mean, you were the only one in the Fright Zone who actually cared enough to come and find me-”

“I tried to convince Catra to come and rescue you,” Scorpia explained, trying to meet Entrapta’s eye, “but she was terrified of Hordak finding out-”

‘Hordak… finding out?’ Entrapta thought.

Entrapta whirled around to look at Scorpia. Her eyes were unnaturally focused, making Scorpia feel like the Princess was drilling holes in her.

“Hordak finding out?” Entrapta asked, using her hair to grab Scorpia by her shoulders. “Hordak finding out about what?”

“About Catra going behind his back and sending you to Beast Island,” Scorpia said slowly, as if that fact was obvious.

“So he really didn’t know…”

Scorpia shook her head, her brows furrowing.

“Well, then what did he think happened to me?”

“I- uh.”

“Come on, Scorpia, give me details!” Entrapta shook Scorpia by the shoulders and rose higher into the air.

“Okay, okay! Well- Uh… The day you were sent to Beast Island, the Princesses invaded the Fright Zone. Catra told Hordak you let them in and left the Fright Zone with them. He thought… He thought you betrayed him.”

“He thought I…” Entrapta’s hair loosened, and she set herself back on the ground. The Princess looked away from Scorpia, letting her hair fall off her shoulders. “He thought *I* betrayed him.”

“Yeah, he was pretty torn up about it, too.”

“He was?” Entrapta flipped up her mask, the sparkle in her eyes coming back.

“Oh yeah, he spent weeks sulking about it, and then when Catra got him out on the battlefield, he spent most of the time looking for you, hoping he could fight you. Well, he said he wanted to fight you, but I think he just wanted to see you.”

“He wants to see me?” She asked, hope trickling into her tone.

Scorpia nodded, a smile forming on her face.

Entrapta couldn’t believe it. She had been trying to tell herself that Hordak didn’t know about her disappearance for months, only to find out it was actually true. She wanted to cry. She wanted to faint. She was in utter shock.

Did this mean he actually cared about her? Did he love her as she did? She needed to know, but he was a million miles away.

“Well then, what am I doing standing around?” Entrapta exclaimed. Entrapta practically flew to the main console of the ship. Her hair broke apart into dozens of little tendrils that began tapping away. Holographic screens flickered on, their light giving Enttrapta an ethereal glow. “Scorpia, go tell Bow and Adora that the ship should be ready in a matter of weeks!” Entrapta

announced, her trademark smile returning to her face. “We’re getting our friends back!”

“Well- Ha ha. That sounds great!” Scorpia replied. “I’ll go tell them!”

With that, Scorpia left the ship, gallivanting off into some unknown direction that Entrapta was too distracted to care about.

‘He just wanted to see you.’

Entrapta’s heart kept fluttering as Scorpia’s words kept replaying in her head. Entrapta wished she had recorded it so she could put it on a permanent loop.

Entrapta’s eyes scanned over the ship’s diagnostics. Repairing the ship was going to take time, time that Entrapta hoped they had. Then, of course, there will be a series of tests to see if the ship can withstand the expansive chaos of space: crushing pressure, freezing temperatures, vaporization, etc.

Entrapta had total faith in her abilities to fix the ship, but a little clarity about what she was working with would help.

“EMILY!” Entrapta shouted, looking over her shoulder. *Weird*, Entrapta thought the bot was somewhere in the ship. Entrapta popped her head out of the ship and called the bot again. Emily

then popped out of a bush and scrambled into the ship with the Princess. “Remember that day Hordak told me all about space ships, Emily?”

Emily beeped affirmatively, noticing her creator had regained some of her spunk.

“Great!” Entrapta clapped her hands together. “Could you play it for me?”

Emily wasted no time pulling up the recording. The flickering light materialized into Hordak’s sanctum, the light blue tint blurring the sharper lines in the background.

Entrapta’s breath caught in her throat when Hordak came into frame. This particular recording was back before the portal explosion, so he still had his old armor. Despite this, he had ditched his cape. Entrapta remembers that day. Hordak had torn a hole in it while working and had abandoned it, muttering something about fixing it later.

“Rewiring the Fright Zone is nearly complete,” he announced, his baritone voice sounding slightly grainy coming out of Emily’s speakers. “We should be able to begin building the portal’s frame in a few days.”

Entrapta heard herself squealing somewhere out of frame. A moment later, she appeared, walking on her hair.

“I’m so excited!” Entrapta exclaimed. “I’ve already started sketching blueprints,” she explained with a sing-song voice. Entrapta practically shoved a datapad into Hordak’s hands. Hordak studied the digital sketches, his brow furrowing in concentration.

“I believe this one will be best with what materials we have to work with.” Hordak handed back the datapad, and Entrapta hugged it to her chest.

“That sounds great! We can start finalizing the design tomorrow!”

For a brief moment, the pair went quiet. The hour had grown quite late, but neither of them was the least bit tired.

“Well… I guess I need to turn in,” Entrapta said sheepishly. “Gotta work at my most optimal, right? He-heh.”

“I do recall saying that, yes.”

Current Entrapta giggled to herself. She remembered during the first week of working together when Hordak kicked her out of his lab. Entrapta had been working in there for nearly twenty-four hours and was practically walking around like a zombie when Hordak told her that she “Needed to work at her most optimal.” Entrapta’s half-asleep self had laughed so hard when he said that. Every day after that, Entrapta would always parrot the statement

before going to bed. Sometimes she would even get a chuckle out of Hordak.

Looking back at the recording, Entrapta watched herself almost walk away, but she stopped herself.

“Unless…” Entrapta drawled, “Is there anything else you wanted to work on or talk about?” Entrapta held the datapad behind her back, nervously fiddling with its case.

“I suppose,” Hordak mused. After a moment, the warlord’s eyes lit up. “I could tell you about spaceships.”

“What are those?” Entrapta asked enthusiastically.

What followed was one of Entrapta’s fondest memories. Hordak went on to explain what a spaceship was, the light never leaving his eyes. It was the most Hordak ever spoke to her in one sitting, and he had this subtle, excited tone that Entrapta just now could decipher. At one point, Hordak dragged over a whiteboard to draw out the ships he could recall. Entrapta even complimented on the drawings, causing Hordak’s ears to flicker.

Current Entrapta listened intently to Hordak, taking note of every ship function he explained. However, something made her focus falter. At one point, past Entrapta started babbling about something. Current Entrapta knew she should pay attention to her past self, but something about Hordak drew Entrapta in.

He had that same soft expression from her dream.

End Notes

Entrapta will later go on to discover how terrible living as a clone of the Galactic Horde is, and she becomes even more determined to save Hordak.

Also, in my timeline, the star projection thing did happen, but it DEFINITELY didn't happen like this. I definitely plan on writing a fic about it, along with a fic about their inside joke.

Thank you for reading, and comment if you feel like it.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!